

ENOUGH GRACE

TEXT: John 1:14 (KJV) “*The Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us, (and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth.*”

John 1:17 (KJV) “*The law was given by Moses, but grace and truth came by Jesus Christ.*”

INTRO: My observation of John one, and the entirety of the New Testament, for that matter, is that it is a discourse on the

Grace of God.

In John one we are told two things:

- Jesus came into the world filled with Grace and Truth...
- Moses gave the law, which was rigid and unbending – Jesus introduced Grace followed by Truth...

GRACE THAT GOES FIRST

Notice in both verses in John one that Grace goes first.

When it comes to the grace of God, there is a term I would like to utilize; “*Prevenient Grace.*” Prevenient grace is that grace which goes before, and is a precursor to human involvement or action.

Every believer can look back and see this prevenient grace at work in his or her life.

Dr. A. H. Strong says: “*The old theologians talked of prevenient grace — grace that lays hold of us before we know it, and prepares us for the emergencies of the future.*”

Prevenient grace is grace that gets there first, or it is the guarantee of Enough Grace:

- Grace was already available when man sinned... (Lamb slain from the foundation of the world)
- Grace furnished the strength for Noah as he built and boarded the Ark...
- Grace sustained Elijah despite the death threats and drought...
- Grace never ceased despite Samson's sin...
- Grace propelled the first century believers even though the path was difficult...

THE DEMONSTRATION OF GRACE IN THE PAST, PRESENT, AND FUTURE TENSE

Grace:

- Reigned in eternity past...
Revelation 13:8 “*Jesus was slain from the foundation of the world.*”
- Reigns in real time... 1
Peter 1:20 “*Jesus was foreordained from the foundation of the world but is manifest in these last times.*” In real time He is administering grace, or executing it as He planned long ago!
- Will reign in eternity to

come... *“He is from everlasting to everlasting.*
God told Moses, *“I am that I am”* meaning He is the one who was, is and will be. The eternal one; the self-existent one!

HOW MUCH GRACE IS ENOUGH GRACE?

Grace was enough for our:

- Redemption...
- Regeneration...
- Justification...
- Sanctification...

Just a touch of Grace:

- Covers us when we least deserve it...

- Releases us from our fiercest bondages...
- Opens up doors that were permanently shut to us...
- Provides a way of escaping judgment...
- Intervenes when sin is present...
- Delivers when the enemy persists...
- Allows us a chance at heaven...

Father God established a covenant of grace in eternity past, which is evidence of enough Grace for every situation and circumstance that we find ourselves in.

If God through Grace made provision for the redemption of man before there ever was a man, then He has already taken care of tomorrow's problems today! That is how the Grace of God works. Trust me, there is no shortage of Grace – God's Grace is enough!

CONCLUSION:

Let me close with one final scripture; 2 Corinthians 12:7-10 (NKJV) *“Lest I should be exalted above measure by the abundance of the revelations, a thorn in the flesh was given to me, a messenger of Satan to buffet me, lest I be exalted*

above measure. ⁸ Concerning this thing I pleaded with the Lord three times that it might depart from me. ⁹ And He said to me, “My grace is sufficient for you, for My strength is made perfect in weakness.” Therefore most gladly I will rather boast in my infirmities, that the power of Christ may rest upon me. ¹⁰ Therefore I take pleasure in infirmities, in reproaches, in needs, in persecutions, in distresses, for Christ’s sake. For when I am weak, then I am strong.”

Paul’s “*thorn in the flesh*” is very simple, “*A messenger of*

Satan sent to cause him trouble.” Literally, everywhere he went he had a revival and caused a riot – he had problems like no-one I have ever known.

Look at what the Lord said to Him ***“My grace is sufficient for you, My strength is made perfect in weakness.”*** Though Paul had lots of problems God was letting him know:

- Grace would be there when he arrived...
- Grace would stay as long as he was there...
- Grace would be more than enough...

- Grace would linger until he exited...

God is letting us know today:

- Grace will arrive before the crisis develops...
- Grace will remain as long as the crisis persists...
- Grace will be more than enough for the challenge...
- Grace will remain until the exit strategy has been carried out...

Jesus left this grace for us! It belongs to us! It is here for us! The only question remaining is whether we will accept it or reject it?